

MARK JEFFERY

Marketing @ Microsoft: The Value of Customer Perception

The security guidance campaign was incredibly important for Microsoft. We knew we had to deliver the guidance broadly to have the desired impact and therefore needed to measure our reach and results. The keys to success were designing the campaign to be measured and building agility into the campaign so that we could change things on the fly.

—Kristin Johnsen, senior director of Security Outreach, Microsoft Corporation

Microsoft Overview

In 2004 Microsoft Corporation, located in Redmond, Washington, was the world's largest software company, with a market capitalization of \$279 billion and \$32 billion in revenue (see **Exhibit 1** for summary financials). Microsoft grew significantly throughout the 1990s, with average revenue growth of 36 percent, by changing the game of the personal computer industry—shifting the control from hardware to software vendors with the widely used Microsoft Windows operating system (OS).

As the size of the company grew, the business portfolio also expanded from PC and server software to games, services, and non-PC software. To manage the complex mix of diverse business units, Microsoft restructured into seven business unit profit and loss segments (P&Ls) (see **Exhibit 2** and **Exhibit 3**):

- *Windows Client*, including the Microsoft Windows XP desktop OS, Windows 2000, and Windows Embedded OS
- *Information Worker*, including Microsoft Office, Microsoft Publisher, Microsoft Visio, Microsoft Project, and other standalone desktop applications
- *Microsoft Business Solutions*, including Great Plains and Navision business process applications and bCentral business services
- *Server and Tools*, including the Microsoft Windows Server System integrated server software, software developer tools, and MSDN

- *Mobile and Embedded Devices*, featuring mobile devices such as the Windows Powered Pocket PC, the Mobile Explorer microbrowser, and the Windows Powered Smartphone software platform
- *MSN*, including the MSN network, MSN Internet Access, MSNTV, MSN Hotmail, and other Web-based services
- *Home and Entertainment*, including Microsoft Xbox, consumer hardware and software, online games, and Microsoft's TV platform

This structure was designed to give full autonomy to each P&L and enable each to grow its business independently.

However, as Microsoft founder Bill Gates described, "We use this structure to make sure that things are delegated and measured and fairly autonomous, and then we have various mechanisms that keep these P&Ls working together."¹ Microsoft needed the units to work together in order to leverage integrated innovation such as Longhorn (renamed Vista in 2006), the next OS version, and to react to threats that were common across the P&Ls. These threats included security; Linux, the open source OS; and the possible European Union decision to prevent Microsoft from bundling new applications into Windows.

Microsoft Marketing

In 2003 Microsoft had invested \$3.9 billion in marketing. More than 4,500 marketing professionals worldwide were focused on Microsoft's vision: to inspire people to realize their potential by choosing Microsoft technologies. As shown in **Exhibit 4A**, marketing responsibilities were divided primarily among three groups: the corporate marketing group (CMG), business group marketers (BG marketers), and subsidiary marketers (sub marketers).

CORPORATE MARKETING GROUP

The CMG was responsible for the company's worldwide marketing and communications strategies. Specifically, the CMG delivered expertise in advertising, event planning, packaging, research, and public relations. Marketers in the CMG were responsible for marketing the company as a whole and managing the Microsoft brand.

BUSINESS GROUP MARKETERS

Marketers in each of Microsoft's business groups were tasked with delivering product and business-level marketing strategies and solutions, including gathering customer input, creating business group product lines and marketing plans, leading cross-business-group process to prioritize go-to-market campaigns, and setting revenue, sales, and marketing targets. The BG marketers were also charged with working with sales on selling models, communicating with field business group leads on topics such as progress against business group sales and marketing plans, coordinating pricing and licensing decisions across business group products (within the corporate pricing and licensing framework), and coordinating audience activities for all business

¹ Jay Greene, "Microsoft: Can It Overcome Its Midlife Crisis?" *BusinessWeek*, April 19, 2004.

groups. Finally, these marketers were expected to champion the product management discipline for the business group.

PRODUCT MANAGERS

Product managers were a critical component of each business group marketing team, responsible for the core success of each product business by driving strategy, managing the business, and delivering key marketing and sales support tools for their products (see **Exhibit 4B**).

SUBSIDIARY MARKETERS

Microsoft's subsidiary marketers were the integration and orchestration point for the business groups in the field. They were responsible for integrated marketing, planning, and delivery, including:

- Developing and executing effective connected marketing strategies that supported solution selling across all customer and partner segments to drive growth and improve satisfaction
- Orchestrating cross-subsidiary teams to ensure alignment and enable parallel execution across Microsoft's diverse business opportunities and customer needs
- Establishing the deepest and broadest customer connections in the industry

Strategic Alignment

A clear imperative for Microsoft was ensuring that marketing spend was aligned with corporate strategy. To facilitate this alignment, Microsoft had defined approximately twenty go-to-market objectives (GTMs) during the 2003 fiscal year. Each GTM included a specific set of products designed to address identified customer pain points (needs) or scenarios. Marketing managers could then map their campaigns to the respective GTMs. Each campaign was designed to create a heightened level of awareness and demand around certain GTMs at specified points of time in the year.

Microsoft specifically wanted to increase its solution selling and needed consistency of messaging for marketing. The GTMs, which focused all the major stakeholders on customer needs, connected sales, and marketing, became a statement about the company-wide priorities. These objectives facilitated alignment across internal teams around a common set of priorities, enabling partners to understand and embrace these priorities.

The GTMs provided a clear framework to bring sales, marketing services, and partner activities into alignment, as well as ensure Microsoft was delivering a consistent set of messages to customers, whether they heard them from a Microsoft account manager, partner, telesales rep, or marketing campaign. In addition, the GTMs provided a set of tools so that marketing campaign managers could align the objectives of specific campaigns with the overarching corporate marketing strategy.

Security: A Strategic Initiative

Microsoft developed strategic business initiatives to drive cross-corporate and global field-integrated execution in complex ongoing campaigns. These initiatives reflected customer pain points or scenarios that were not directly supported by a specific set of products.

In 2003 two serious security events had threatened IT users, especially Microsoft platform users: SQL Slammer and MS Blaster. The SQL Slammer, which spread in January 2003, targeted Microsoft SQL databases in corporate systems. MS Blaster, which began spreading in October 2003, specifically targeted Windows 2000 and Windows XP machines. This worm² was designed to infect other PCs, disturb network traffic, and disable the Windows update function of the PC. The primary target of MS Blaster was actually Microsoft.com, as the worm initiated a denial of service attack on the Microsoft.com Windows update center.

Security issues continue to plague computer users every day. For example, in August 2003 four new types of worms attacked the Microsoft platform during a single week.³ The trend for hackers and worm developers to specifically target the Microsoft platform—the most installed OS in the world—led to a customer perception that Microsoft technology had problems with security and quality.

For Microsoft, which made more than half its profit from PC and server platform products, responding to the security attacks became a required action. To maintain the status quo in its core business, Microsoft needed to provide a means to protect its customers from the security attacks. As a result of the constant security issues, customers demanded to know: What was Microsoft doing about quality? How easy was it to get a patch or update when a vulnerability was found in the software? What guidance, tools, and training were available?

The call of the Internet in 1995, and this notion that we were being left behind, was a defining moment for our company. I think this issue, this crisis right now that our customers and our partners are highlighting for us of security, is that kind of defining moment. . . . it's not an issue for Microsoft and ISVs and you alone; it's really an issue that we have to explain to people and train people and educate people as an issue we need to attack together as an industry with our customers.

—Steven A. Ballmer, CEO, Microsoft Corporation
(October 9, 2003, Worldwide Partner Conference)

In October 2003 Microsoft launched the security mobilization initiative (SMI) to execute on security image and satisfaction commitments with IT professionals and consumers. SMI focused on five commitments: build security guidance, deliver security messages, enable the worldwide field and partners to address customer security needs, train IT professionals and developers, and respond in a timely and accurate manner to security issues. Security guidance was the most scaleable and powerful resource that could be delivered consistently in a highly visible manner to help customers take steps to improve their security. The Microsoft security execution strategy began to take shape focusing on the following internal objectives:

² “A malicious program that replicates itself until it fills all of the storage space on a drive or network,” <http://www.dictionary.com> (accessed June 16, 2006).

³ Michelle Delio, “Geeks Grapple with Virus Invasion,” *WIRED News*, August 21, 2003.

- Build security guidance
- Deliver security guidance through multiple channels: the Web site, seminars, and publications
- Train Microsoft internal and worldwide field resources to address customer security needs
- Empower partners globally, including Hewlett-Packard and Dell, to communicate security issues and solutions with one voice
- Respond reliably and accurately to security issues

Security Guidance

The best security programs reflect proactive, disciplined execution enabled by good security guidance and training. The best time to read the instructions to the fire extinguisher are before the alarm goes off.

—Lori Woehler, CISSP, CISA, director,
Security Technology Unit, Microsoft Corporation

Microsoft was able to demonstrate that its platform was as secure as any other platform in the market when it participated in the *eWeek*-sponsored OpenHack competition in November 2002.⁴ Five vendors, including Microsoft, were invited by *eWeek* to build a representative corporate e-business system, and prizes were given to hackers who penetrated these systems and disabled them.

In 23 days the Microsoft system faced 82,500 attacks, yet had 100 percent uptime. But we learned something incredibly important from this experience: we had the dream team of Microsoft security—think Shaquille O’Neal, Michael Jordan, and Yoda. We realized that we needed to get the knowledge from our Microsoft security experts out to our users.

—Jonathan Perera, senior director of marketing communications,
Security Technology Unit, Microsoft Corporation

For success in the *eWeek* competition Microsoft required the full-time commitment of its best team to achieve 100 percent uptime, which was unrealistic in practice for the vast majority of corporate customers. The event made Microsoft realize that it needed to focus on prescriptive guidance to help customers better address security using their existing technologies for activities like patch management and protection against worms and viruses. Hence, Microsoft started to create an enterprise-focused marketing campaign.

Consumer PC security required less complexity than enterprise customers. A separate campaign was developed with online calls to action to “Protect Your PC” (PYPC) with three steps published at www.microsoft.com/pypc:

⁴ Timothy Dyck, “As OpenHack Test Nears End, Vulnerability Comes to Light,” *eWeek*, November 11, 2002, <http://www.eweek.com/article2/0,1759,1576916,00.asp>.

- Use a firewall
- Apply software updates
- Use up-to-date antivirus software

This content was coordinated with channel partners; Wal-Mart, for example, syndicated content around PYPC for its PC customers.

Microsoft.com

Microsoft.com was the corporate Web presence of Microsoft Corporation and its “face to the public.”⁵ In 2004 the Microsoft.com mission statement was: “Through the innovative use of Microsoft software, Microsoft.com provides a global exchange of ideas, knowledge, and technology that helps people incorporate the full value of technology into their lives and businesses.” For the majority of Microsoft’s customers, Microsoft.com was the only vehicle for interaction with Microsoft.

Microsoft.com began as a small Web site hosted on a single server. By March 2004, however, Microsoft.com had grown to house more than 109 GB of content and 3.2 million files totaling 575 GB. More than five hundred writers and developers in more than seventy locations worldwide actively provided information for the Microsoft Web site.

The Microsoft.com network consisted of more than 160 content destinations that shared a common platform. This network allowed for extensive reach—in 2004 Microsoft.com was the fourth most utilized site in the United States, according to Comscore Media Metrix, reaching 62.8 million users and 42 percent of the total U.S. Internet audience. Approximately 8 million unique users visited Microsoft.com each day; seventy-seven international sites provided value-added content in thirty-six languages, as well as core Microsoft corporate and product information for local market customers.

Marketing Campaign Prioritization Strategy for Microsoft.com

Microsoft.com used a tiering and ranking system to help the Media and Marketing team segment all incoming marketing requests into one of four designations (Tiers 1, 2, 3, and 4) and provide a level of service and number of ad impressions accordingly.

In fiscal year 2004 Microsoft.com planned to use a ranking system employing the use of a new decision analysis tool (**Exhibit 5**). The tool would incorporate ten inputs and assign a quantitative value and weight to each. The resulting number would allow Microsoft.com to measure campaigns against one another. Additionally, Microsoft.com regularly solicited input from key marketing groups such as the CMG to assure that their priorities were synchronized.

⁵ Microsoft.com should not be confused with MSN.com; Microsoft.com is “about Microsoft” and provides customers with relevant information about Microsoft products and services, whereas MSN.com is a network of Internet services designed to enable customers to manage their own Internet experience and access the full power of the Web.

Tier 1 campaigns were identified via the decision analysis tool and in consultation with the U.S. business marketing group (US-BMO) and CMG as the highest-priority marketing initiatives taking place across the corporation. It was projected that Microsoft.com would be able to service three or four of these campaigns at any given time and the campaign life would span no more than three months.

Tier 2 campaigns were identified as cross-audience campaigns that merited broad coverage on Microsoft.com and a centrally managed media plan. The campaigns were lower priority than Tier 1. It was projected that Microsoft.com would be able to service ten to twelve of these campaigns at any given time, with a campaign life span of not more than three months.

Tier 3 campaigns were identified as single-audience campaigns that merited broad coverage on Microsoft.com but not a centrally managed media plan. Microsoft.com was capable of serving five of these campaigns per audience at any given time, with a campaign life span of not more than two months.

Tier 4 campaigns were identified as site-specific campaigns that would not show up in the house ad spots but on the content pane of a particular Web site.

These four different tiers of campaigns had differing priority levels for Microsoft.com—Tier 1 was the highest priority, and Tier 4 was the lowest.

Security Guidance Campaign

The Web fundamentally changes marketing. Rather than big-bang one-shot campaigns, the Web enables coordinated incremental programs that can be fine-tuned based on real-time customer data.

—Jerret West, lead business development manager,
Microsoft.com Media and Marketing

To address the security needs of IT professionals in the enterprise and mid-market segments, Microsoft launched a campaign to provide a one-stop security solutions site for this group—forming a single portal for IT professionals to keep informed and take necessary actions. See **Exhibit 6** and visit the Web site at www.microsoft.com/security/guidance.

The project positioned the Web site Security Guidance Center as the centerpiece of the program. The Web site, which was designed to be a one-stop gateway to deliver in-depth security tools and information to IT specialists, was supported by an integrated marketing approach with print and online ad placement to drive the target audience to the Web site (see **Exhibit 7**). Furthermore, Microsoft defined three specific goals for this campaign:⁶

- Get customers to take action to address security
- Make customers understand that they needed to make a long-term commitment to implementing security properly. Security was not a one-time action but rather a process,

⁶ Microsoft Unified Marketing Brief: Template, June 6, 2003.

and through these immediate efforts, Microsoft was committed to helping customers protect their environments successfully today and in the future

- Drive customers to visit www.microsoft.com/security for regular, up-to-date, effective, and prescriptive assistance and to register to receive security newsletters with proactive guidance and bulletins for security update and issues

These goals had three main metrics to define success:

- Improve customer satisfaction for Microsoft security by five points in fiscal year 2004, relative to the baseline fiscal year 2003 customer satisfaction survey
- Train 500,000 IT professionals in security
- Engage 100 percent of enterprise customers to identify and register security contacts to receive topical newsletters with proactive guidance and bulletins for security updates and issues that required timely action

These were ambitious goals, which the team understood. What would make a big difference, however, was that the Web site would be leveraged to track progress against these goals, quantify the effectiveness of the ad campaign, and fine-tune the project as it was running.

Security Guidance Center Web Site

Launched in February 2004, Security Guidance Center was the primary landing page to deliver IT professionals all the necessary tools and information on security for Microsoft products. The site emphasized content that required IT people to take action (“calls to action”) and housed all the relevant security information, or links to additional information. The site consisted of five main components: the primary calls to actions, core prescriptive content, links to the Security Program Guide, campaign calls to actions, and navigation.

The primary calls to action were at the core of the Security Guidance Center content. The main page had four links to the events and tools which Microsoft delivered:

- Register for training: three kinds of events, including in-person events, live Webcasts, and on-demand Webcasts
- Get tools: Microsoft Baseline Security Analyzer (MBSA) and Software Update Services (SUS)
- Preorder the security guidance kit CD-ROM
- Sign up for security newsletters and bulletins

The core prescriptive content was the in-depth security information that was updated frequently. This content was divided into five subcategories, enabling the audience to reach topics of interest easily. The specific subcategories were security topics, products and technologies, how-to articles, checklists, and modules.

Security Program Guide Web Site

Security Program Guide was the centralized landing page for all security-related events and programs. To address the large number of diverse events run by Microsoft, Security Program Guide was designed to clearly lead the target audience through the available options without overwhelming them with irrelevant information. Security Program Guide offered the audience options to register and sign up for events, programs, and communications.

Integrated Marketing

The campaign was fully integrated. The print ads, analysts, press relations, partner communications, and Web site were all managed to go live simultaneously. “On the same day all the cylinders were firing,” said Jonathan Perera. The campaign planning began in mid-2003, with the campaign brief and initial engagement with Microsoft.com occurring in mid-December. Weekly meetings took place throughout the month of January, and the campaign launched in mid-February 2004.

Microsoft.com was engaged at the appropriate point in the planning process, and the Security Guidance Center was integrated into the overall Microsoft.com design structure. The Security Guidance Center was easily found from the home page of Microsoft.com, the TechNet home page, and the security main page.

Microsoft.com positioned Security Guidance Center as a Tier 1 campaign, giving high priority with structured implementation of campaign management and integration with other media plans. As a Tier 1 campaign, MSCOM Publishing committed to deliver a premium advertising plan, including:

- A minimum of 25 million impressions per month across the Microsoft.com network, including newsletters and search terms
- Centrally developed media plan listing flight schedule and impressions by site
- Weekly impression and click reporting by site and creative elements
- Biweekly optimization of placements and acquisition reporting
- Perceptual study measuring demographics of visitors, online/offline advertising effectiveness, and VSAT(very satisfied)/DSAT(dissatisfied)
- Orchestration of additional marketing vehicles on Microsoft.com such as blogs, chats, Webcasts, and newsletter special editions

Evaluation Methodologies

To evaluate the success of the campaign, Microsoft tracked two types of information: the changes in perceptions of the target audiences and the effectiveness of the ad promotions it ran. In tracking the audience’s perception, Microsoft used an online survey in addition to the annual IT perception tracker survey. To track the effectiveness of the ads, Microsoft collected data on the audience’s ad click-through rates and the pages they visited once inside the site. The online

survey enabled monthly updates on customer perception and satisfaction, and the click-through analysis enabled weekly feedback on the site.

CLICK-THROUGH ANALYSIS

Microsoft collected the data on the audience's Web browsing behavior to analyze the effectiveness of the Security Guidance Center/Security Program Guide page design and each ad promotion. Effectiveness was measured by the number of actions taken as a result of the Web design or the ad promotion. Sample data collected from February 2004 is shown in **Exhibit 8** and **Exhibit 9**. These data describe which media placement led the audience to the Security Guidance Center page and what specific actions they took (or which calls to action they clicked).

To analyze the browsing behavior within the Security Guidance Center/Security Program Guide site, the actions taken by the audience were classified into three steps:

- *Initial Responses.* The number of times the desired initial action was taken (i.e., click-throughs, visits to specific URLs)
- *Intermediate Action(s).* Action step between initial response and desired end action (i.e., signing up for newsletter, downloading software, etc.)
- *End Actions.* The number of customers who completed the desired end action (i.e., downloaded software, registered for an event, etc.)

TAKING QUICK ACTION

The Security Guidance Center click-through analysis after the first week (see Exhibit 8) gave insight into how the campaign was working. The four calls to action of the Security Guidance Center were generating a 54 percent intermediate action rate: Security Program Guide (24.5 percent), Security Guidance Kit (14.6 percent), Security Tools (9.8 percent), and Security Notification (5.7 percent). The Security Program Guide call to action was getting the highest number of intermediate actions.

The original banner ad campaign broadly advertised the Security Guidance Center and related programs, and the ads were designed to click through directly to the Security Guidance Center. However, these data suggested that the Security Program Guide had a higher rate of generating intermediate actions from online ads, 29 percent, compared with Security Guidance Center, 18 percent.

As a result of these data, the marketing team decided to refocus the campaign in late February. Launched in mid-March, the new ads promoted only the Security Summits, with a direct click-through to the Security Program Guide. In addition, the Security Program Guide page was modified to emphasize a single call to action: the Security Summits.

ONLINE SURVEY

The online survey collected data using a pop-up methodology with a target sample of more than 2,500 in a four-month period (March–June 2004). When a visitor exited the www.microsoft.com/security/guidance page, she would be presented with a small pop-up window inviting her to participate in an online survey. If the visitor decided to participate, the survey would open in a new browser window. If the visitor chose not to participate, the pop-up window would close and she could continue with her visit as usual.

The survey was designed to collect the following data (see **Exhibit 10** for sample questions):

- Profile of visitors to the Web site (e.g., United States vs. international, taxonomy, organization size, etc.)
- Reasons for visiting the Web site
- Means of arriving at the Web site (e.g., Microsoft.com banner ad, publications, etc.)
- Satisfaction with Web site content
- Source of security information other than Microsoft
- Aided awareness of advertising campaign
- Interest levels in the four calls to action of the advertising campaign
- Likelihood to participate in the four calls to action of the advertising campaign in the future
- Agreement with advertising campaign messaging statements
- Perceptions of Microsoft overall
- Satisfaction with Microsoft overall

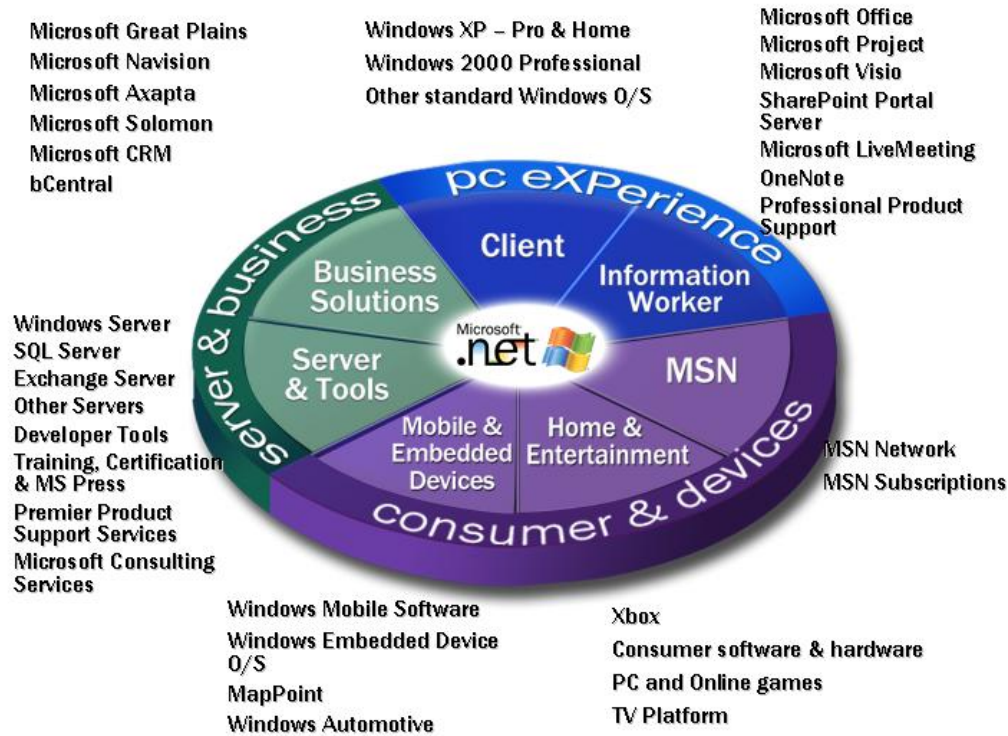
Exhibit 11 shows a sample of the monthly online survey analysis for the questions relating to customer perception regarding Microsoft and security, and **Exhibit 12** shows numerical results for the customer perception questions. In combination with the detailed monthly click-through rates (Exhibit 9), these data gave important insight into whether or not the refocusing of the Security Guidance campaign was working.

Exhibit 1: Microsoft Income Statement

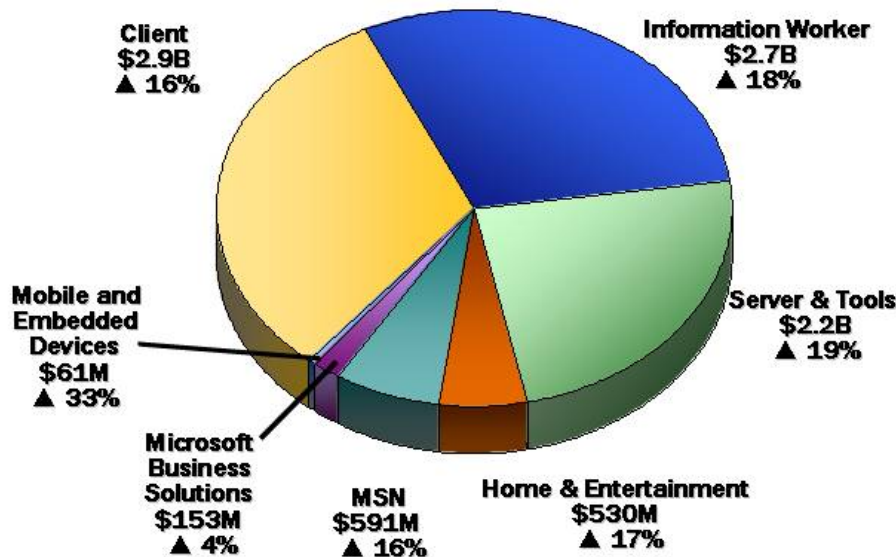
	FY1998	FY1999	FY2000	FY2001	FY2002	FY2003
Revenue	\$15,262	\$19,747	\$22,956	\$25,296	\$28,365	\$32,187
Operating expenses:						
Cost of revenue	2,460	2,814	3,002	3,455	5,699	6,059
Research and development	2,601	2,970	3,772	4,379	6,299	6,595
Acquired in-process technology	296	0	0	0	0	0
Sales and marketing	2,887	3,238	4,126	4,885	6,252	7,562
General and administrative	433	715	1,050	857	1,843	2,426
Other expenses	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total operating expenses	8,677	9,737	11,950	13,576	20,093	22,642
Operating income	6,585	10,010	11,006	11,720	8,272	9,545
Losses on equity investees and other	(207)	(70)	(57)	(159)	(92)	(68)
Investment income	739	1,951	3,326	(36)	(305)	1,577
Noncontinuing items	0	0	0	0	0	0
Income before income taxes	7,117	11,891	14,275	11,525	7,875	11,054
Provision for income taxes	2,627	4,106	4,854	3,804	2,520	3,523
Net income before accounting change	4,490	7,785	9,421	7,721	5,355	7,531
Cumulative effect of accounting change				(375.0)		
Net income	4,490	7,785	9,421	7,346	5,355	7,531
Preferred stock dividends	(28)	(28)	(13)	0	0	0
Net income available for common shareholders	4,462	7,757	9,408	7,346	5,355	7,531
Basic EPS before accounting change	0.46	0.77	0.91	0.72	0.50	0.70
Diluted EPS before accounting change	0.42	0.71	0.85	0.69	0.48	0.69
Basic earnings per share	0.46	0.77	0.91	0.69	0.50	0.70
Diluted earnings per share	0.42	0.71	0.85	0.66	0.48	0.69

Source: Microsoft Corporation Web site, <http://www.microsoft.com/msft/history.mspx>.

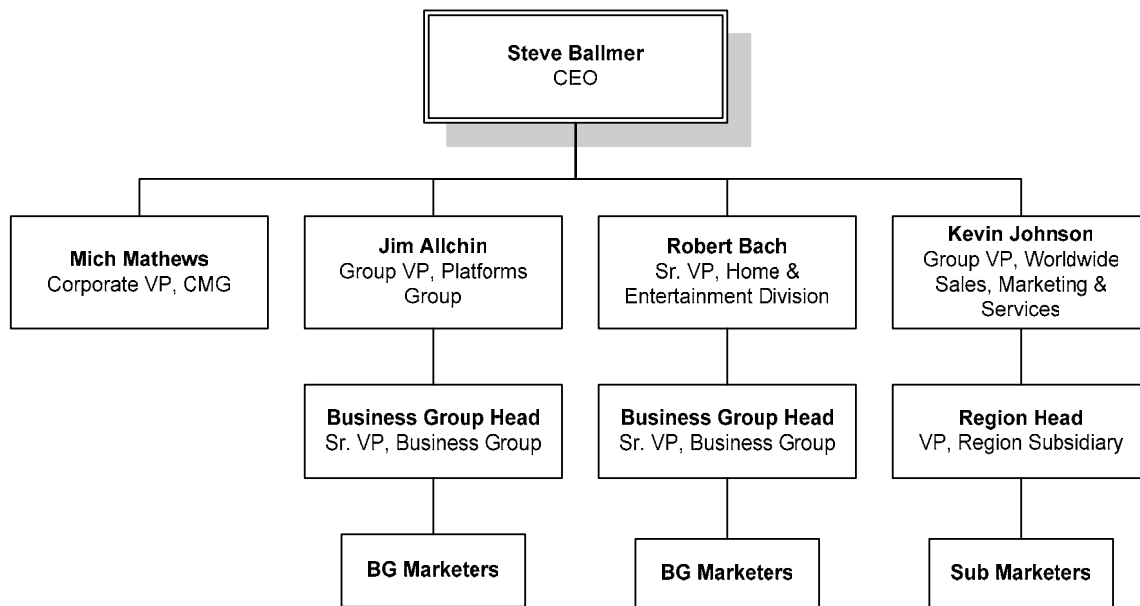
Note: Dollars in millions, except earnings per share.

Exhibit 2: Products and Services of the Seven P&Ls

Source: Microsoft Corporation, Third Quarter Results, April 22, 2004.

Exhibit 3: Revenue by the Seven P&Ls

Source: Microsoft Corporation, Third Quarter Results, April 22, 2004.

Exhibit 4A: Marketing Organization Chart**Exhibit 4B: Detailed Role of Product Managers**

BUSINESS STRATEGY	BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	KEY DELIVERABLES
• Thought leadership • Vision and strategy • Product planning and road map • Market development strategy • Competitive intelligence • Customer segment scenarios	• Pricing • SKUs • EULA/licensing • Competitive analysis • Market research • Fiscal year and long-term business plan and alignment with other groups	• Pricing • SKUs • EULA/licensing • Competitive analysis • Market research

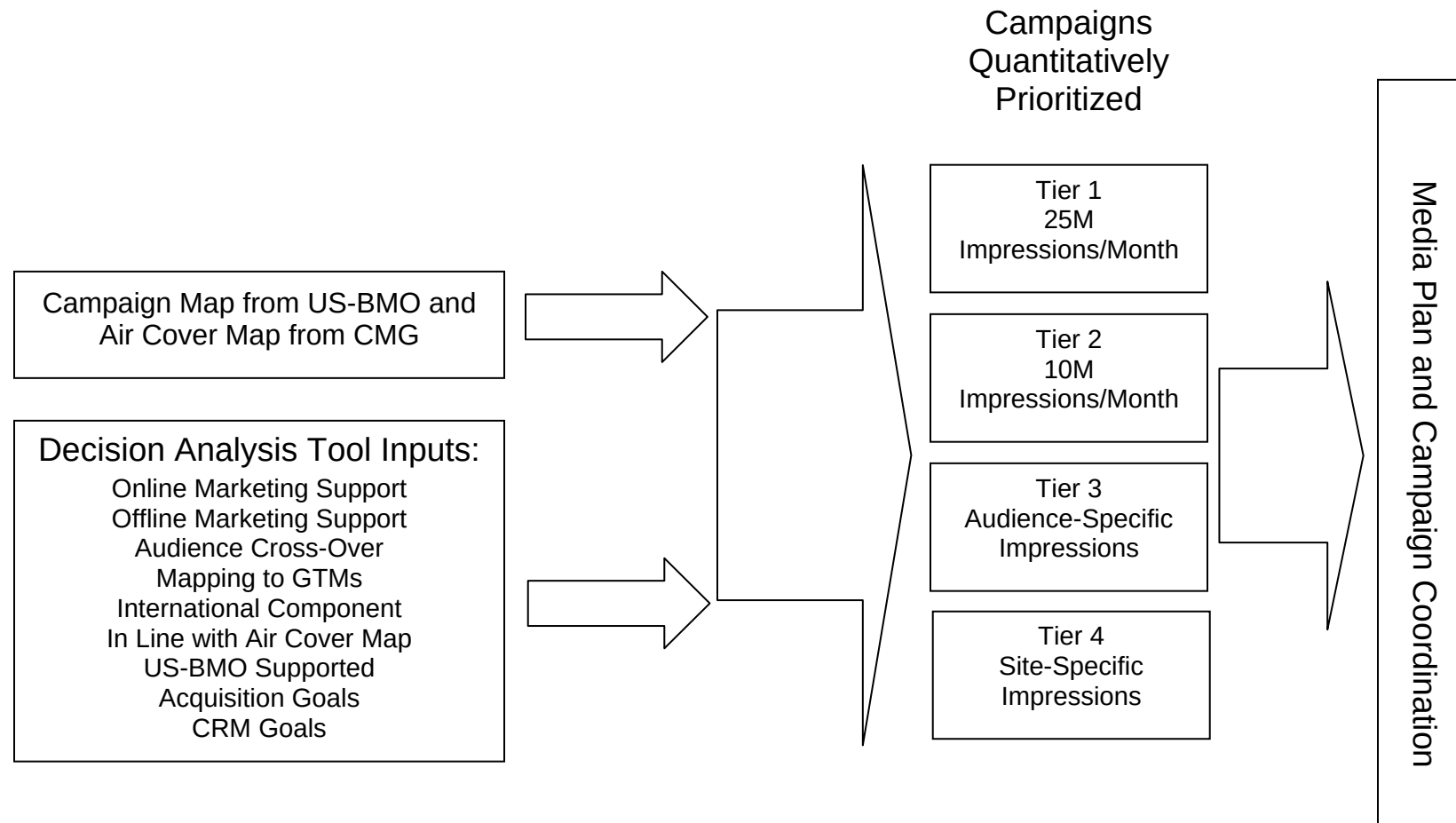
Exhibit 5: Microsoft.com Marketing Campaign Prioritization Structure

Exhibit 6: Security Guidance Main Page

Security Guidance Center - Microsoft Internet Explorer

File Edit View Favorites Tools Help

Back Forward Stop Home Search Favorites Media

Microsoft.com Home | Site Map

Microsoft

Search Microsoft.com for: Go

Microsoft Security

Security & Privacy Home

- Security Guidance Center
- Recently Published
- Security Topics
- Products & Technologies
- How-To Articles
- Security Checklists
- Security Modules
- Worldwide Security Guidance Centers

Protect Your PC
Security guidance for personal computer users

Security Guidance Center for Small Businesses

Security Guidance Center for Developers and IT Pros

Get the technical guidance, tools, training, and updates you need to assist you in planning and managing a security strategy that's just right for your organization.

- Register for training
- Get tools
- Order the security guidance kit CD
- Sign up for security communications

Free Security Training

Free Security Training
Find free security management training, including a security summit in a city near you, weekly security webcasts, and in-depth e-learning.

More Security Resources for:

- TechNet (IT Pros)
- Developers (MSDN)

Security Tools

Security Tools
Find tools such as the Microsoft Baseline Security Analyzer (MBSA) that can streamline patch management and help you better secure your infrastructure.

Security E-Mail

Security Communications
Quickly and easily sign up for the free Microsoft Security Notification Service and the free Microsoft Security Newsletter—two important components in our ongoing effort to provide regular and relevant information about the latest security issues.

Report a Security Vulnerability in a Microsoft Product

Recently Published

[View the latest additions to the Security Guidance Center](#)

Security Topics
Find a wide array of articles that cover important security issues.

- Patch Management
- Desktop Security
- Server Security
- More Topics...

Products and Technologies
Look here for product- and technology-specific guidance that will help you protect your platforms, networks, desktops, and data.

- Windows XP
- Windows 2000
- Windows Server 2003
- More Products and Technologies...

How-to Articles
Get step-by-step instructions for a broad range of security-related tasks.

Exhibit 7: Security Guidance Center Overview

Security Guidance Center:
invest advertising and MSCOM placements in franchise destination
turn up volume on select campaign calls to action (i.e. summits) as business requires

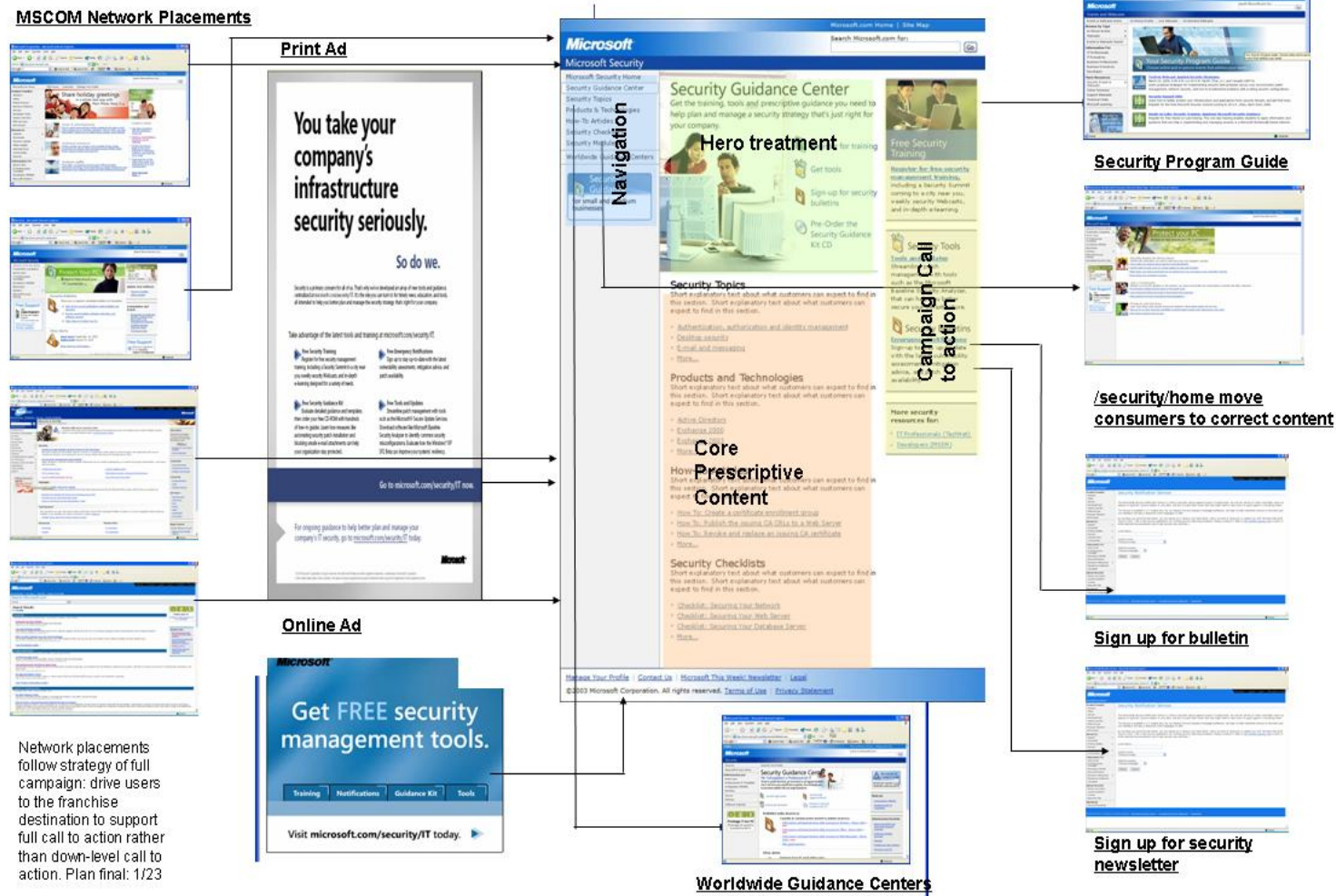


Exhibit 8: Monthly Incremental Click-Through Analysis for Security Guidance Center

Data through Feb '04

Security Guidance Center		Initial Responses	Total Intermediate Actions¹	Intermediate Action Rate	Total End Actions¹	Continued Action Rate (CAR)
Print Ad		597	325	54.4%	4	0.7%
<i>Call to Action Tracking</i>						
Security Program Guide			146	24.5%		
Security Guidance Kit			87	14.6%		
<i>Security Tools</i>						
Baseline Security Analyzer			38	6.4%		
Software Update Service - Client					4	0.7%
Software Update Service - SP1			20	3.4%		
<i>Security Notification</i>						
Microsoft Security Newsletter			0	0.0%		
Security Notification Bulletin			34	5.7%		
Online Advertising	Prime	418	49	11.7%	-	0.0%
	<i>Call to Action Tracking</i>					
	Security Program Guide		33	7.9%		
	Security Guidance Kit		10	2.4%		
	<i>Security Tools</i>					
	Baseline Security Analyzer		2	0.5%		
	Software Update Service - Client				0	0.0%
	Software Update Service - SP1		2	0.5%		
	<i>Security Notification</i>					
	Microsoft Security Newsletter		0	0.0%		
	Security Notification Bulletin		2	0.5%		
	Search	31	3	9.7%	-	0.0%
	<i>Call to Action Tracking</i>					
	Security Program Guide		2	6.5%		
	Security Guidance Kit		0	0.0%		
	<i>Security Tools</i>					
	Baseline Security Analyzer		1	3.2%		
	Software Update Service - Client				0	0.0%
	Software Update Service - SP1		0	0.0%		
	<i>Security Notification</i>					
	Microsoft Security Newsletter		0	0.0%		
	Security Notification Bulletin		0	0.0%		
	Task	1,757	355	20.2%	4	0.2%
	<i>Call to Action Tracking</i>					
	Security Program Guide		182	10.4%		
	Security Guidance Kit		65	3.7%		
	<i>Security Tools</i>					
	Baseline Security Analyzer		74	4.2%		
	Software Update Service - Client				4	0.2%
	Software Update Service - SP1		10	0.6%		
	<i>Security Notification</i>					
	Microsoft Security Newsletter		0	0.0%		
	Security Notification Bulletin		24	1.4%		
Microsoft Web Placements		16,116	2,689	16.7%	41	0.3%
<i>Call to Action Tracking</i>						
Security Program Guide			960	6.0%		
Security Guidance Kit			618	3.8%		
<i>Security Tools</i>						
Baseline Security Analyzer			638	4.0%		
Software Update Service - Client					41	0.3%
Software Update Service - SP1			251	1.6%		
<i>Security Notification</i>						
Microsoft Security Newsletter			0	0.0%		
Security Notification Bulletin			222	1.4%		
SUBTOTAL		18,919	3,421	18.1%	49	8.2%

Exhibit 9: Click-Through Analysis: Detailed Track of Media Effectiveness—Security Summit

Security Summit - Initial Response

Marketing Component	Start / Mail Date	Total Impressions	Delivered Impressions	21-Feb-04	28-Feb-04	6-Mar-04	13-Mar-04	20-Mar-04	27-Mar-04	3-Apr-04	10-Apr-04	17-Apr-04	24-Apr-04	Actual Clicks to Date	Actual Response Rate (%)
E-mail Tracked by FWLink															
New York (NY)	24-Mar-04								274	78	8	1	1	362	
New York	24-Mar-04								186	35	14	1		236	
Raleigh	24-Mar-04								110	35	24			169	
Washington	24-Mar-04								432	120	14		1	567	
Minneapolis	24-Mar-04								105	33	11	28		177	
Chicago	24-Mar-04								344	44	15	14		417	
Denver	24-Mar-04								180	80	25	11		296	
Phoenix	24-Mar-04								255	45	14	188	25	527	
<i>Email Initial Response Subtotal:</i>		-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,886	470	125	243	27	2,751	
Other (Direct Mail, E-mail & Misc.)															
Event Flyers- RSA in February; CTA integrations	25-Mar-04			2	9	28	3	9	8	2	7	6		74	
Partner e-mail and flyers				2			1	5	35	780	258	554	48	1,683	
Generic Field/Sales Template URL				75	115	186	280	215	350	150	100	156	108	1,735	
Posters and centralized URL				198	118	4,016	4,319	2,304	400	3,988	4,600	5,038	4,086	29,067	
Keyword Searches											41	117	3,336	3,494	
<i>Other Initial Response Subtotal:</i>		-	-	277	242	4,230	4,603	2,533	793	4,920	5,006	5,871	7,578	36,053	
Microsoft Web Placements															
Microsoft Web Placements (from Security Program Guide) to Security Summit Page		84,563	84,563	1,305	1,351	1,012	2,938	4,715	3,779	3,572	3,022	2,210	2,372	26,276	31.1%
www.microsoft.com/exchange/		194,982	194,982	-	-	-	-	225	427	518	680	559	445	2,855	1.5%
msdn.microsoft.com/		2,102,526	2,102,526	-	-	-	-	316	7,987	2,364	1,519	464	4	12,655	0.6%
www.microsoft.com/technet/default.msp		1,116,312	1,116,312	-	-	-	-	4,648	5,740	5,737	10,069	8,077	8,723	42,995	3.9%
www.microsoft.com/		26,143,740	26,143,740	-	-	-	-	13,593	17,764	21,797	6,098	76	60	59,388	0.2%
www.microsoft.com/windowsserver2003/default.msp		289,680	289,680	-	-	-	-	545	847	791	864	785	752	4,583	1.6%
www.microsoft.com/windowsserversystem/default.msp		456,840	456,840	-	-	-	-	1,132	2,055	2,189	2,128	2,660	1,438	11,602	2.5%
<i>Microsoft Web Placements Initial Response Subtotal:</i>		30,388,643	30,388,643	1,305	1,351	1,012	2,938	25,175	38,597	36,968	24,380	14,832	13,795	160,354	0.5%
Microsoft Newsletter Placements															
Business Newsletter		115,503	115,503	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	258	258	0.2%
Microsoft for Partners		87,220	87,220	0	0	0	0	0	0	508	25	8	6	546	0.6%
Microsoft Security Newsletter		103,085	103,085	0	0	0	1,024	185	39	12	9	522	80	1,870	1.8%
Microsoft: This Week!		2,136,328	2,136,328	0	0	70	244	158	152	181	180	166	106	1,255	0.1%
MSDN Flash		312,855	312,855	0	0	0	0	0	420	38	25	7	8	498	0.2%
TechNet Flash		788,955	788,955	0	0	0	0	94	9	3,462	337	159	43	4,103	0.5%
Windows Platform News		813,805	813,805	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,621	129	629	32	2,410	0.3%
<i>Microsoft E-newsletters Initial Response Subtotal:</i>		4,357,751	4,357,751	-	-	70	1,268	436	620	5,821	705	1,490	533	10,941	0.3%
Initial Response Total		34,746,394	34,746,394	1,582	1,593	5,312	8,809	28,144	41,896	48,179	30,216	22,436	21,933	210,099	0.6%
Security Summit Site Activity (www.microsoft.com/seminar/securitysummit/default.msp)															
Web site - Page Views				1,344	1,156	2,608	14,048	15,400	15,928	23,736	17,716	14,392	13,828		
Actual Registrations by Week				439	262	794	1,272	1,528	1,741	3,293	1,980	1,302	940		
Cumulative Registrations by Week				439	701	1,495	2,767	4,295	6,036	9,329	11,309	12,611	13,551		
% of total goal achieved				2%	3%	5%	10%	15%	22%	33%	40%	45%	48%		
Misc. Program Guide Tracking															
External newsletters to Program Guide					11	3	310	305	120	22	131	7		909	
External e-mail to Program Guide					1					1				2	
Direct Mail to Program Guide						2	7	7	18	367	236	181	171	989	
Misc. Program Guide Initial Response Total				-	12	5	317	312	138	390	367	188	171	1,900	

Exhibit 10: Online Questionnaire Sample—Perception Questions

23. Please rate how much you agree or disagree with the following statements about Microsoft Corporation. (RADIO BUTTON TABLE)

	Strongly Agree					Strongly Disagree						
	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]		
	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1		S.N.	S.A.S.
Microsoft is committed and responsible about security	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	58		
Microsoft is committed to providing secure products	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	59		
Microsoft provides information that helps you get secure and stay secure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	60		
Microsoft provides tools and resources to help secure products	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	61		
Microsoft does enough to make me aware of security issues	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	62		
Microsoft adequately informs customers how to protect their computing environment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	63		

B24. How well does Microsoft meet your expectations with regards to security? (RADIO BUTTON -HORIZONTAL)

Exceeds Expectations					Does Not Meet Expectations At All						
[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]		
9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1		S.N.	S.A.S.
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	64	

B25. Please tell us how your visit to the Microsoft Security Guidance Center Web site today influenced your satisfaction with Microsoft Corporation? (RADIO BUTTON - HORIZONTAL)

Increased My Satisfaction With Microsoft					Decreased My Satisfaction With Microsoft						
[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]	[Code]		
9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1		S.N.	S.A.S.
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	65	

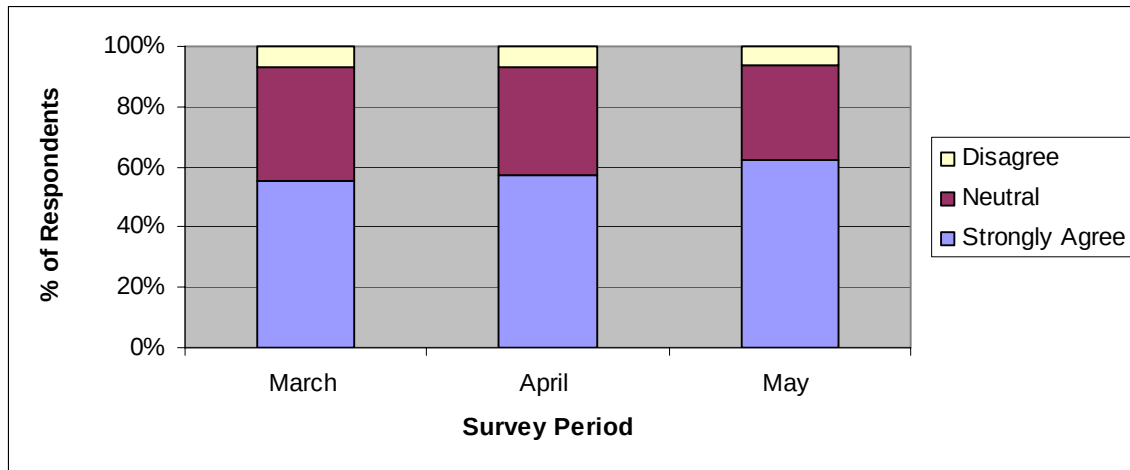
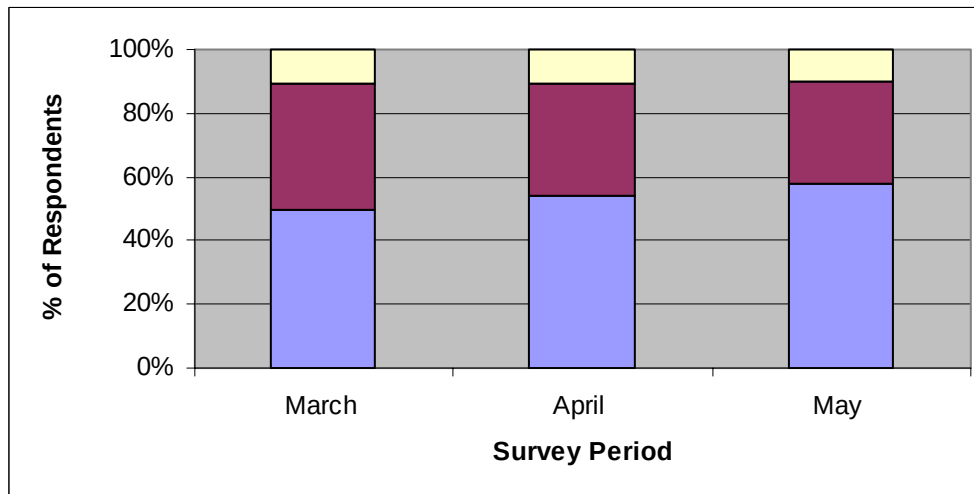
Exhibit 11: Online Survey Results**Microsoft provides tools and resources to help secure products****Microsoft is committed to providing secure products**

Exhibit 12: Numerical Data for the Online Survey Results

		March Total	April Total	May Total
Microsoft provides tools and resources to help secure products	Sample size	895	1,510	861
	Strongly Agree (%)	55	57	62
	Neutral (%)	37	36	32
	Disagree (%)	7	7	6
Microsoft is committed and responsible about security	Sample size	902	1,509	862
	Strongly Agree (%)	52	56	61
	Neutral (%)	37	34	31
	Disagree (%)	11	10	8
Microsoft provides information that helps you get secure and stay secure	Sample size	898	1,508	863
	Strongly Agree (%)	51	55	59
	Neutral (%)	39	37	34
	Disagree (%)	10	8	7
Microsoft is committed to providing secure products	Sample size	895	1,513	865
	Strongly Agree (%)	50	54	58
	Neutral (%)	39	35	32
	Disagree (%)	11	11	10